to discover some form of truth which no skepticism can attack. In other words, we must set our sights not on what we would like to know, but first on what we do know with certainty.

Now then, among all the facts that we do know and can report to each other, which is the one that is absolutely the most certain, the one that is not open even to the most minute doubt? This question admits of but one answer: "That which we experience with our own body." And since exact science deals with the exploration of the outside world, we may immediately go on to say: "They are the impressions we receive in life from the outside world directly through our sense organs, the eyes, ears, etc." If we see, hear or touch something, it is clearly a given fact which no skeptic can endanger.

To be sure, we speak also of illusions, but never with the intention of implying that the sense perceptions involved are incorrect or even questionable. For instance, when a person happens to be deceived by a mirage, the fault lies not with his perception of the visual image, which is actually present, but in his inferences which draw false conclusions from the given sensory data. The sensory impression is always a given fact, and therefore incontestable. What conclusions the individual attaches to it, is another story, which need not concern us for the time being. Therefore, the content of the sensory impressions is the most suitable and only unassailable foundation on which to build the structure of exact science.

If we call the sum total of sensory impressions *"the sense world,"* we may state briefly that exact science issues from the experienced sense world. The sense world is that which, so to speak, furnishes science with the raw material for its labors.

However, this seems to be a very meager result. For the content of the sense world is, in any case, only something of a subjective character. Every individual has his own senses, and in general, the senses of one individual are quite different from those of another, whereas the aim of exact science is to achieve objective, universally valid knowledge. It may seem, therefore, that in adopting our present approach we have been following the wrong track.

But we must not jump to conclusions. For it will become manifest that considerable progress can be made along the line of advance now open to us. Considered as a whole, the matter reduces itself to the fact that we human beings have no direct access to the knowledge conveyed to us by exact science, but must acquire it one by one, step by step, at the cost of painstaking labors of years and centuries.

Now, if we examine the content of our sense world, it obviously falls apart into as many separate fields as we have sense organs—there is a field corresponding to sight, another to hearing, and still others corresponding to the senses of touch, smell, taste and heat. These fields are totally different from each other, and have initially nothing in common. There is no